

Phillip Keelan

Web Developer

Contact

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Education

Dev Academy Aotearoa

Certificate in Applied Software
Development Level 6

NZ Army

Lead Teams Leadership
Rifle Platoon Commander
Senior NCO
Advanced Trackers
Snipers Supervisors
Health and Safety Coord
Certificate in Business Level 3
Outdoor Recreation Level 4

Work Safe

Health and Safety Representative

Flip Global

Flip Learning Level 2

Technical Skills

JavaScript
React.js
Git
SQLite
Restful APIs
Chakra UI
Tailwind

Human Skills

Communication
Leadership
Collaborator
Team Influencer
Agile Methodology
Innovative Problem Solving

About

I'm a full-stack web developer with nearly 20 years of military experience in the Royal New Zealand Infantry Regiment (RNZIR), where I specialized in intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance. My time in the military taught me a lot about discipline, leadership, strategic thinking, and staying calm under pressure. I've managed complex operations, led diverse teams in high-risk situations, and developed resilience and adaptability—skills that I now bring to software development.

Since transitioning into tech, I've become passionate about building innovative and reliable solutions that improve safety, efficiency, and user experience. I'm excited to apply my technical skills across different industries and believe strongly in the power of technology to create positive change. I enjoy learning new things, working collaboratively, and using my problem-solving skills to develop impactful software that makes a difference.

Experience Summary

- Dev Academy Aotearoa 2025
- Royal New Zealand Infantry Regiment 2006 – 2025
- Great Southern Film and Television 2022
- Backpacking Adventures 2017-2018

Web Development Experience

Dev Academy Aotearoa

2025

Experience

This was an intense 15 week training period, totalling approximately 800 hours, that simulates working in a high stress modern development team. The course teaches:

- Create full-stack web applications using modern technologies such as React, Tailwind CSS, SQLite3, and Node.js.
- Employ testing, restful APIs, and database relationships.
- Human skills to improve collaborate in group projects as well as personal growth in high stress environments

Projects

We were expected to be part of multiple projects from solo, pair programming, and group projects. For me two projects stood out.

Tao Koi Tracker

My personal project focused on creating a web application that created a database out of years of experience in my head and allow it to be displayed through as required. This would aide military visual trackers.

Motivating Mike

Our final group project focused on creating a todo list with a motivational avatar that encouraged you to get a task done.

You can find both of these projects on my github profile.

Previous Career Experience

Royal New Zealand Infantry Regiment, New Zealand Army

2006 – 2025

Leadership

- Led and managed teams of 40+ personnel across various high-pressure environments, ensuring operational success through strategic planning, coordination, and leadership.
- Deployed internationally to Timor-Leste, Afghanistan, and Iraq, serving as Second-in-Command, Team Leader, Instructor, and Mid-Senior Leader, demonstrating adaptability and tactical expertise.
- Coordinated and supported small, agile teams supporting operations within New Zealand and abroad, often in high-risk environments requiring quick decision-making and resilience.
- Developed and mentored emerging leaders to operate effectively within dynamic and high-stakes environments.

Technical Knowledge

- Provided expert advice to senior leadership on the coordination and deployment of intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance assets, maximising operational efficiency.
- Identified operational flaws and implemented innovative solutions to improve procedures, safety, and mission outcomes.
- Established and maintained relationships with multiple agencies, forces, and cultures, facilitating cross-organisational collaboration.
- Planned, organised, and executed major exercises and training courses, some up to six weeks long, often independently managing logistics and support.
- Designed and implemented comprehensive risk management and medical evacuation plans to ensure team safety and mission success.

Backpacking Adventures

2017 – 2018

- Travelled to over 30 countries, gaining cultural awareness and interpersonal skills by navigating diverse social and communication boundaries.
- Developed strong adaptability skills by managing cultural sensitivities and respecting local customs while planning and executing travel logistics.

Great Southern Film and Television

2022

Maintained personal proficiency in industry skills and provided expert advice on service delivery, contributing to project success and client satisfaction.

Honours and Awards

- NZ Operational Service Medal – For serving on military operations
- NZ General Service Medal Timor-Leste – For service on operations within Timor-Leste
- NZ General Service Medal Afghanistan – For service on operations within Afghanistan
- NATO Medal – For participation in NATO-led operations conducted in Afghanistan
- NZ General Service Medal Iraq – For service on operations within Iraq
- Long Service and Good Conduct Medal – For 14 years unblemished service
- NZ Defence Service Medal (Regular Clasp) – For 3 years of service within the military regular force
- Timor-Leste Solidarity Medal – For service in stability and peace operations in Timor-Leste
- Operation Deans Citation – For first response to Christchurch Mosque shooting.

References (Available on request)